



CODE CHALLENGE: Solve the Profile HMM Problem.

Input: A threshold θ , followed by an alphabet Σ , followed by a multiple alignment

Alignment whose strings are formed from Σ .

Output: The transition matrix followed by the emission matrix of $HMM(Alignment, \theta)$.

Note: Your matrices can be either space-separated or tab-separated.

Extra Dataset (<http://bioinformaticsalgorithms.com/data/extradata/hmm/ProfileHMM.txt>)

Sample Input:

```
0.289
-----
A B C D E
-----
EBA
E-D
EB-
EED
EBD
EBE
E-D
E-D
```

Sample Output:

```
      S      I0      M1      D1      I1      M2      D2      I2      E
S      0      0      1.0      0      0      0      0      0      0
I0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0
M1      0      0      0      0      0.625  0.375  0      0      0
D1      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0
I1      0      0      0      0      0      0.8    0.2    0      0
M2      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      1.0
D2      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      1.0
I2      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0
E      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0
-----
      A      B      C      D      E
S      0      0      0      0      0
I0      0      0      0      0      0
M1      0      0      0      0      1.0
D1      0      0      0      0      0
I1      0      0.8    0      0      0.2
M2      0.143  0      0      0.714  0.143
D2      0      0      0      0      0
I2      0      0      0      0      0
E      0      0      0      0      0
```

Time Limit: 5 mins

To solve this problem please visit stepic.org/lesson/-11632/step/2



We saw in a previous chapter that multiplication by zero can cause problems when finding a most likely object. Our workaround there was to introduce pseudocounts to prevent this multiplication.

In the case of a profile HMM, for example, say that we transition from state *A* to state *B* with probability 0.833, state *A* to state *C* with probability 0.167, and state *A* to state *D* with probability 0. In the current setup, it is not possible for a path passing from state *A* to state *D* to have nonzero weight. Yet adding a pseudocount of 0.01 to each of these probabilities, then renormalizing, results in the following updated transition probabilities after rounding to three decimal places:

$$\Pr(A \rightarrow B) = (0.833 + 0.01) / ((0.833 + 0.01) + (0.167 + 0.01) + (0 + 0.01)) = 0.818$$

$$\Pr(A \rightarrow C) = (0.167 + 0.01) / ((0.833 + 0.01) + (0.167 + 0.01) + (0 + 0.01)) = 0.172$$

$$\Pr(A \rightarrow D) = (0 + 0.01) / ((0.833 + 0.01) + (0.167 + 0.01) + (0 + 0.01)) = 0.010$$

This discussion brings us to the following problem.

Profile HMM with Pseudocounts Problem: *Construct a profile HMM with pseudocounts from a multiple alignment.*

Input: A multiple alignment *Alignment*, a threshold value θ , and a pseudocount value σ .

Output: $\text{HMM}(\text{Alignment}, \theta)$, in the form of transition and emission matrices.



CODE CHALLENGE: Solve the Profile HMM with Pseudocounts Problem.

Input: A threshold θ and a pseudocount σ , followed by an alphabet Σ , followed by a multiple alignment *Alignment* whose strings are formed from Σ .

Output: The transition and emission matrices of $\text{HMM}(\text{Alignment}, \theta, \sigma)$.

Note: Your matrices can be either space-separated or tab-separated.

Extra Dataset (<http://bioinformaticsalgorithms.com/data/extradata/hmm/ProfileHMMPseudocounts.txt>)

Sample Input:

0.358 0.01

A B C D E

A-A

ADA

ACA

A-C

-EA

D-A

Sample Output:

	S	I0	M1	D1	I1	M2	D2	I2	E
S	0	0.01	0.819	0.172	0	0	0	0	0
I0	0	0.333	0.333	0.333	0	0	0	0	0
M1	0	0	0	0	0.398	0.592	0.01	0	0
D1	0	0	0	0	0.981	0.01	0.01	0	0
I1	0	0	0	0	0.01	0.981	0.01	0	0
M2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.01	0.99
D2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.5	0.5
I2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.5	0.5
E	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

	A	B	C	D	E
S	0	0	0	0	0
I0	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
M1	0.771	0.01	0.01	0.2	0.01
D1	0	0	0	0	0
I1	0.01	0.01	0.327	0.327	0.327
M2	0.803	0.01	0.168	0.01	0.01
D2	0	0	0	0	0
I2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
E	0	0	0	0	0

Time Limit: 5 mins

To solve this problem please visit stepic.org/lesson/-11632/step/4



Sequence Alignment with Profile HMM Problem: *Align a new sequence to a family of sequences using a profile HMM.*

Input: A multiple alignment *Alignment*, a threshold value θ , a pseudocount value σ , and a string x .

Output: An optimal hidden path emitting x in $\text{HMM}(\text{Alignment}, \theta, \sigma)$.





CODE CHALLENGE: Solve the Sequence Alignment with Profile HMM Problem.

Input: A string x followed by a threshold θ and a pseudocount σ , followed by an alphabet Σ , followed by a multiple alignment *Alignment* whose strings are formed from Σ .

Output: An optimal hidden path emitting x in $\text{HMM}(\text{Alignment}, \theta, \sigma)$.

Extra Dataset (<http://bioinformaticsalgorithms.com/data/extradata/hmm/AlignmentWithHMMPProfile.txt>)

Sample Input:

```
AEFDFDC
-----
0.4 0.01
-----
A B C D E F
-----
ACDEFACADF
AFDA---CCF
A--EFD-FDC
ACAEF--A-C
ADDEFAAADF
```

Sample Output:

```
M1 D2 D3 M4 M5 I5 M6 M7 M8
```

Time Limit: 5 mins

To solve this problem please visit stepic.org/lesson/-11632/step/6

HMM Parameter Estimation Problem: Find optimal parameters explaining the emitted string and hidden path of an HMM.

Input: A string $x = x_1 \dots x_n$ emitted by a k -state HMM with unknown transition and emission probabilities following a known hidden path $\pi = \pi_1 \dots \pi_n$.

Output: A transition matrix *Transition* and an emission matrix *Emission* that maximize $\Pr(x, \pi)$ over all possible transition and emission matrices.

If we know both x and π , then we can compute empirical estimates for the transition and emission probabilities using a method similar to one we used for estimating parameters for profile HMMs. If $T_{l,k}$ denotes the number of transitions from state l to state k in the hidden path π , then we can estimate the probability $transition_{l,k}$ by computing the ratio of $T_{l,k}$ to the total number of transitions leaving state l ,

$$transition_{l,k} = \frac{T_{l,k}}{\sum_{\text{all states } j} T_{l,j}}.$$

Likewise, if $E_k(b)$ denotes the number of times symbol b is emitted when the hidden path π is in state k , then we can estimate the probability $emission_k(b)$ as the ratio of $E_k(b)$ to the total number of emitted symbols from state k ,

$$emission_k(b) = \frac{E_k(b)}{\sum_{\text{all symbols } c \text{ in the alphabet}} E_k(c)}.$$

It turns out that the above two formulas for computing *Transition* and *Emission* result in parameters solving the HMM Parameter Estimation Problem.



CODE CHALLENGE: Solve the HMM Parameter Estimation Problem.

Input: A string x of symbols emitted from an HMM, followed by the HMM's alphabet Σ , followed by a path π , followed by the collection of states of the HMM.

Output: A transition matrix *Transition* followed by an emission matrix *Emission* that maximize $\Pr(x, \pi)$ over all possible transition and emission matrices.

Extra Dataset (<http://bioinformaticsalgorithms.com/data/extradata/hmm/HMMParameterEstimation.txt>)

Sample Input:

```
yzzyzxzx
-----
x y z
-----
BBABABAB
-----
A B C
```

Sample Output:

```
      A      B      C
A      0.0      1.0      0.0
B      0.8      0.2      0.0
C      0.333     0.333     0.333
-----
      x      y      z
A      0.25     0.25     0.5
B      0.5      0.167    0.333
C      0.333     0.333    0.333
```

Time Limit: 5 mins

To solve this problem please visit stepic.org/lesson/-11632/step/8



HMM Parameter Learning Problem: *Estimate the parameters of an HMM explaining an emitted string.*

Input: A string $x = x_1 \dots x_n$ emitted by an HMM with unknown transition and emission probabilities.

Output: A transition matrix *Transition* and an emission matrix *Emission* that maximize $\Pr(x, \pi)$ over all possible transition and emission matrices and over all hidden paths π .

Unfortunately, the HMM Parameter Learning Problem is intractable, and so we will instead develop a heuristic that is analogous to the Lloyd algorithm for k -means clustering. In that algorithm, we iterated two steps, “From Centers to Clusters”,

$$(Data, ?, Centers) \rightarrow HiddenVector,$$

and “From Clusters to Centers”,

$$(Data, HiddenVector, ?) \rightarrow Centers.$$

As for HMM parameter estimation, we begin with an initial random guess for *Parameters*. Then, we use the Viterbi algorithm to find the optimal hidden path π :

$$(x, ?, Parameters) \rightarrow \pi$$

Once we know π , we will question our original choice of *Parameters* and apply our solution to the HMM Parameter Estimation Problem to update *Parameters* based on x and π :

$$(x, \pi, ?) \rightarrow Parameters'$$

We then iterate over these two steps, hoping that the estimated parameters are getting closer and closer to the parameters solving the HMM Parameter Learning Problem:

$$(x, ?, Parameters) \rightarrow (x, \pi, Parameters) \rightarrow (x, \pi, ?) \rightarrow (x, \pi, Parameters') \rightarrow (x, ?, Parameters') \rightarrow (x, \pi', Parameters') \rightarrow (x, \pi', ?) \rightarrow (x, \pi', Parameters'') \rightarrow \dots$$

This approach to learning the HMM's parameters is called **Viterbi learning**.



CODE CHALLENGE: Implement Viterbi learning for estimating the parameters of an HMM.

Input: A number of iterations j , followed by a string x of symbols emitted by an HMM, followed by the HMM's alphabet Σ , followed by the HMM's states, followed by initial transition and emission matrices for the HMM.

Output: Emission and transition matrices resulting from applying Viterbi learning for j iterations.

Extra Dataset (<http://bioinformaticsalgorithms.com/data/extradata/hmm/ViterbiLearning.txt>)

Sample Input:

```
100
-----
zyzxxzz
-----
x y z
-----
A B
-----
      A      B
A      0.599  0.401
B      0.294  0.706
-----
      x      y      z
A      0.424  0.367  0.209
B      0.262  0.449  0.289
```

Sample Output:

```
      A      B
A      0.5    0.5
B      0.0    1.0
-----
      x      y      z
A      0.333  0.333  0.333
B      0.4    0.1    0.5
```

Time Limit: 5 mins

To solve this problem please visit stepic.org/lesson/-11632/step/10



Soft Decoding Problem: Find the probability that an HMM was in a particular state at a particular moment given its emitted string.

Input: A string $x = x_1 \dots x_n$ emitted by an HMM.

Output: The conditional probability $\Pr(\pi_i = k|x)$ that the HMM was in state k at step i given that it emitted x .

Recall that we computed $forward_{k,i}$ when solving the Outcome Likelihood Problem. If we reverse the edges of the Viterbi graph, we can compute

$$backward_{k,i} = \sum_{\text{all states } l} backward_{l,i+1} \cdot Weight_i(k, l).$$

Here we have that the reversed edge connecting $(l, i+1)$ to (k, i) has weight $Weight_i(k, l) = transition_{k,l} \cdot emission_l(x_{i+1})$.

Combining the forward-backward algorithm described in the lecture with our solution to the Outcome Likelihood Problem for computing $\Pr(x)$ yields that

$$\Pr(\pi_i = k|x) = \frac{\Pr(\pi_i = k, x)}{\Pr(x)} = \frac{forward_{k,i} \cdot backward_{k,i}}{forward(sink)}$$



Profile HMM Problem: *Construct a profile HMM from a multiple alignment.*

Input: A multiple alignment *Alignment* and a threshold θ .

Output: $\text{HMM}(\text{Alignment}, \theta)$, in the form of transition and emission matrices.





CODE CHALLENGE: Solve the Soft Decoding Problem.

Input: A string x , followed by the alphabet Σ from which x was constructed, followed by the states $States$, transition matrix $Transition$, and emission matrix $Emission$ of an HMM (Σ , $States$, $Transition$, $Emission$).

Output: An $|x| \times |States|$ matrix whose (i, k) -th element holds the conditional probability $\Pr(\pi_i = k|x)$.

Extra Dataset (<http://bioinformaticsalgorithms.com/data/extradata/hmm/SoftDecoding.txt>)

Sample Input:

zyxxxxyxzz

x y z

A B

	A	B
A	0.911	0.089
B	0.228	0.772

	x	y	z
A	0.356	0.191	0.453
B	0.040	0.467	0.493

Sample Output:

A	B
0.5438	0.4562
0.6492	0.3508
0.9647	0.0353
0.9936	0.0064
0.9957	0.0043
0.9891	0.0109
0.9154	0.0846
0.964	0.036
0.8737	0.1263
0.8167	0.1833

Time Limit: 5 mins

To solve this problem please visit stepic.org/lesson/-11632/step/12

